

Strength in Numbers: Driving Financial Inclusion for Agroinnovation Members with Esusu/Ajo

Many Agripreneurs face real difficulties when it comes to accessing affordable lump-sum credit or building reliable savings. Traditional financial institutions often have strict requirements and high entry barriers, making it challenging for agripreneurs and innovators to obtain loans or save effectively. In light of these obstacles, long-standing community-based savings schemes such as esusu (Igbo), ajo (Yoruba), and adashe (Hausa) have emerged as practical solutions. These systems have, for generations, promoted financial inclusion, trust, and mutual support, bridging the gap where formal banking services are out of reach.

Esusu schemes have a measurable impact on entrepreneurship: research found that 72.7% of small-scale entrepreneurs achieved their business objectives through participation in esusu, highlighting its effectiveness in supporting business growth and financial goals.

Esusu and Ajo: is a group contribution scheme, simple, transparent, and effective ways to build financial resilience and unlock opportunities together.

Picture a group of Agroinnovation members, each dedicated to supporting one another's growth. Every month, each person contributes a fixed amount into a shared pool. In each cycle, one member receives the entire sum, enabling them to invest in their agribusiness, scale innovations, or address urgent financial needs. Over time, everyone benefits, not just financially, but also through the bonds of trust and cooperation that deepen with every round.

Benefits of the Agroinnovation Group Contribution Scheme

- Access to Lump-Sum Funds:**

Members can access substantial capital at intervals, without the burden of interest or the need for collateral, making it easier to fund important projects or investments.

- Regular Savings Culture:**

The scheme encourages members to save consistently, helping to build healthy financial habits and long-term discipline.

- Community Support:**

By working together, members strengthen their sense of community, building trust and

sharing responsibility for each other's success.

- Financial Safety Net:

The pooled funds provide a reliable cushion in times of emergency or unexpected business needs, reducing financial vulnerability.

- Flexible Use:

Members have the freedom to use the funds for various purposes, whether it is business expansion, innovation projects, or urgent operational costs.

This group scheme offers practical, people-focused solutions to the financial challenges Agroinnovation members face, while also building a stronger, more resilient community.

By uniting through this group contribution scheme, Agroinnovation members can overcome financial barriers and unlock new opportunities for growth. Together, we can build a foundation of trust and support that not only drives success today but can also evolve into a registered cooperative for even greater impact and sustainability in the future.